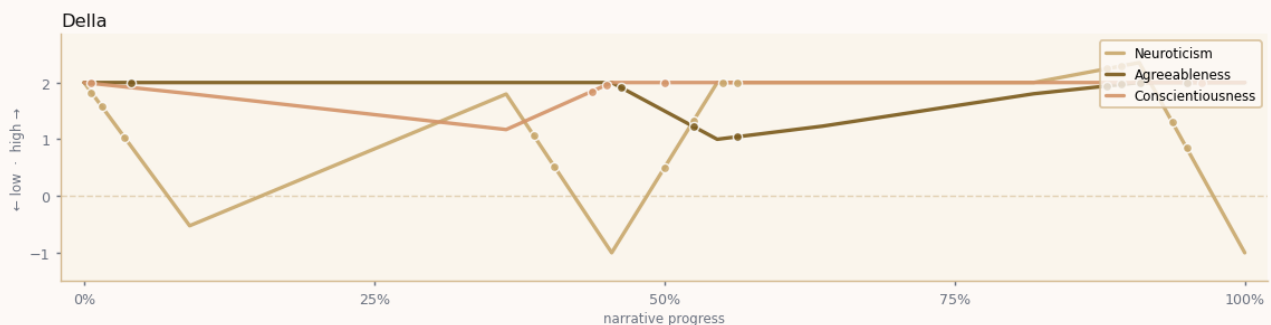


Della

A young married woman in her twenties, living in poverty with her husband Jim. She is the emotional and moral center of the story, driving the plot through her selfless sacrifice of her prized hair to buy her husband a Christmas gift.

20 personality signals

Neurotic		+0.75
Agreeable		+0.70
Conscientious		+0.45



NEUROTIC

Upon discovering the combs, she experiences an "ecstatic scream of joy" followed immediately by "hysterical tears and wails" when she realizes her hair is gone."

"Della counts her meager savings of \$1.87 three times, her cheeks burning with shame at having to bargain so closely with shopkeepers."

"Della flops down on the couch and howls at the realization that she has only \$1.87 to buy Jim a Christmas present."

AGREEABLE

Della has spent "many a happy hour planning for something nice for him," imagining "something fine and rare and sterling—something just a little bit near to being worthy of the honor of being owned by Jim."

"She found it at last. It surely had been made for Jim and no one else... It was like him. Quietness and value—the description applied to both."

"Jim stares at her with an unreadable expression that terrifies her, yet she immediately approaches him and launches into an anxious, breathless explanation of her sacrifice."

CONSCIENTIOUS

Della counts her meager savings of \$1.87 three times, her cheeks burning with shame at having to bargain so closely with shopkeepers."

"Oh, and the next two hours tripped by on rosy wings. She was ransacking the stores for Jim's present."

"When Della reached home her intoxication gave way a little to prudence and reason. She got out her curling irons and lighted the gas and went to work repairing the ravages made by generosity added to love."

EXTRAVERTED

With a whirl of skirts and with the brilliant sparkle still in her eyes, she fluttered out the door and down the stairs to the street."

"Oh, and the next two hours tripped by on rosy wings. She was ransacking the stores for Jim's present."

"She eagerly presents Jim's gift to him, describing her effort to find it and enthusiastically encouraging him to use it frequently."

OPEN-MINDED

Suddenly Della whirls from the window, her eyes shining brilliantly, and pulls down her hair to its full length—a moment of decisive action and sudden inspiration."

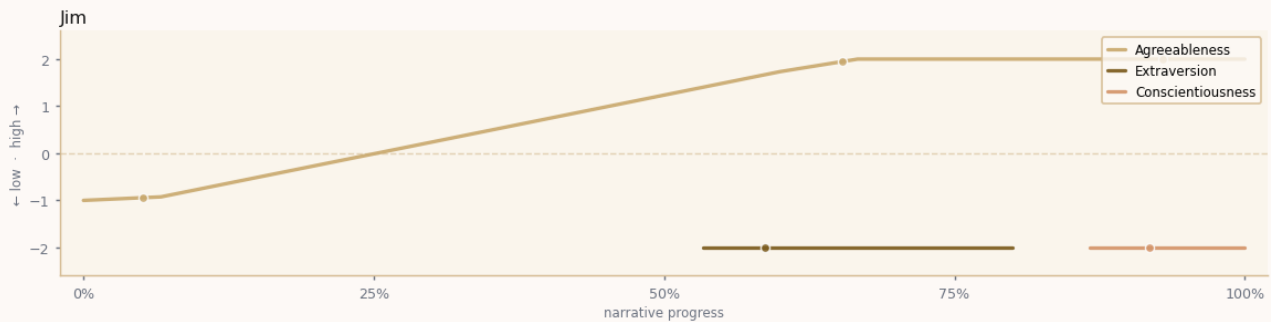
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Jim

Della's husband, twenty-two years old, working as a wage earner for \$20 per week. He is initially silent and unreadable upon discovering Della's sacrifice, but reveals his own act of selfless love by having sold his most treasured possession to buy her a gift.

6 personality signals



AGREEABLE
 Jim suddenly emerges from his trance, embraces Della warmly, and reassures her that nothing could make him like her less, then reveals he has purchased an expensive gift for her.

"Dell, let's put our Christmas presents away and keep 'em a while. They're too nice to use just at present. I sold the watch to get the money to buy your combs. And now suppose you put the chops on."

"Jim's gold watch, inherited from his father and grandfather, is one of the two possessions "in which they both took a mighty pride," and he would pull it out to show the janitor King Solomon out of pride."

INTROVERTED
 Jim stares fixedly at Della with an expression she cannot read, remaining immovable and silent while she speaks."

CAREFREE
 "Instead of obeying, Jim tumbled down on the couch and put his hands under the back of his head and smiled."

NEUROTIC
 Jim asks laboriously about her hair being cut off, as if struggling to process an obvious fact despite "the hardest mental labor," and later repeats the question with "an air almost of idiocy."

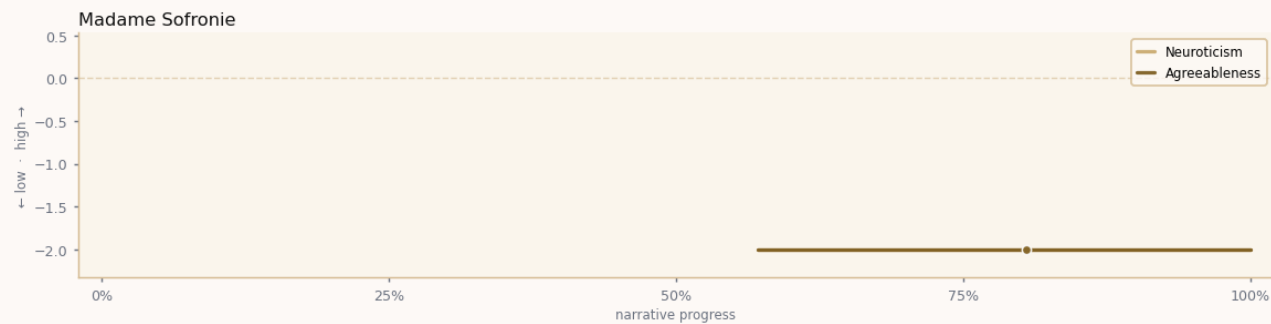


Madame Sofronie

A large, pale woman who operates a hair goods shop. She serves as a minor but essential figure who purchases Della's hair for twenty dollars, enabling the central transaction of the plot.

1 personality signals

Emotionally Stable		-2.00		
Disagreeable		-2.00		



EMOTIONALLY STABLE
"Madame, large, too white, chilly, hardly looked the 'Sofronie.'"

DISAGREEABLE
"Madame, large, too white, chilly, hardly looked the 'Sofronie.'"